

Catalysing Impact 2026 - Expression of Interest

✔ Completed

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Q1. Please confirm your enterprise meets the following criteria:

Australian-incorporated enterprise

Working on solutions that address climate resilience and/or social inclusion

Actively seeking investment or repayable finance in 2026. Reminder: Catalysing Impact is NOT intended for charities seeking donations or grants, it is to support social enterprises to attract investment and funding from sources outside of philanthropy

Q2.

Field label	Response
First Name	Nicholas
Last Name	Marchesi
Enterprise Name	A Curious Tractor (Goods. Project)
Enterprise Location (State)	Queensland
Phone	0424054113
Email	nicholas@act.place

Q3. What is your position/title in your enterprise?

Founder and Lead Designer

Q4. Is your enterprise structured as a for-profit or not-for-profit?

For profit

Q5. If multi-entity or other, please describe your organisation's structure.

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Q6. Briefly describe what your enterprise does.

Goods. manufactures durable, repairable essential goods for remote Australian communities - beds, washing machines, and refrigerators designed for harsh conditions and built from recycled plastic waste. We address a critical gap: standard goods cost 2-5x metro prices in remote communities, fail within months, and end up in landfill - while people sleep on floors and preventable diseases spread due to lack of washing facilities. Our model is waste-to-wealth with community ownership. Every bed diverts 25kg of plastic from landfill. Products are co-designed with First Nations communities, manufactured using containerised on-country production facilities, and 40% of profits return to communities. We've delivered 369+ beds and 20+ washing machines across 8 communities (Palm Island, Tennant Creek, Kalgoorlie, Maningrida, and others), with 200-350 additional beds requested. Our audacious goal: make Goods. beds as ubiquitous in remote Australia as a troop carrier or an Akubra hat.

Q7. Who are the primary beneficiaries?

Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people
Adults
Early childhood
Environment
Financially disadvantaged people
General community in Australia
People in rural, regional, or remote communities
People with disabilities
Youth

Q8. What measurable impact has your enterprise achieved so far?

Share key metrics, if applicable, such as the number of people reached, the reduction in CO2 emissions, or other measurable outcomes demonstrating impact.

Products Delivered:

369+ beds constructed and deployed across 8 communities
20+ washing machines in field testing
1,000+ lives directly impacted (estimated at 2.5 people per asset)

Environmental Impact:

25kg of recycled plastic diverted from landfill per bed
9,225kg+ total plastic diverted to date

Health Impact (evidenced from sector research):

Remote laundries reduce scabies presentations by 60%
For every \$1 invested in remote washing facilities, healthcare saves \$6 in treatment costs
Addressing the direct pathway from scabies → rheumatic heart disease affecting 1 in 3 children in remote communities

Community Economic Impact:

40% profit share committed to artisan communities
500+ minutes of community consultation recorded
Co-design partnerships with Traditional Owners in Tennant Creek, Palm Island, and Alice Springs

Demand Validation:

200-350 bed requests from communities and health organisations

**Q9. What is the intended purpose or use of the investment and funding you are seeking in 2026?
How will that funding be used and what will that help you achieve?
Be as specific as you can and include budgeted amounts where possible.**

2026 funding will scale community-based manufacturing and move us toward financial sustainability:

1. Production Scale-Up (\$120,000)

100 stretch beds for immediate deployment to requesting communities: \$80,000

Complete containerised on-Country production facility: \$60,000

On-Country Production Facility:

Our first-ever on-country production facility transforms community plastic waste into beds through a circular process:

Plastic shredder processes bottle lids and plastic collected by community members

Heated press moulds shredded plastic into waterproof sheets

Computer-controlled router cuts components

Community members assemble flat-pack beds

2. Washing Machine Expansion (\$40,000)

40 additional units for Tennant Creek and Maningrida deployment

3. Working Capital (\$50,000)

Inventory to enable commercial sales and faster community response

Build toward 1,000-bed stock for revenue generation

Total 2026 target: \$210,000 in investment/repayable finance

Q10. Please describe your intended funding sources and how the Catalysing Impact grant would support you in achieving this.

Include the amount and type of funding (revenue, grants, equity, debt, etc.) you are pursuing and who you are speaking with regarding these opportunities.

Current Funding Pipeline:

Confirmed/In Discussion:

Snow Foundation: \$200,000 proposal pending (anchor partner, \$193,785 received to date)

The Funding Network: Relationship established (\$130,000 raised September 2025)

FRRR Backing the Future: \$50,000 received

Vincent Fairfax Family Foundation: \$50,000 received

Social Impact Investment (seeking in 2026):

SEFA (Social Enterprise Finance Australia): In discussion (Joel Bird, 23 communications)

Snow Foundation Social Impact Loan: Offered access to this pathway

Giant Leap (impact VC): Potential fit as we scale

Government/Institutional:

Social Enterprise Development Initiative (SEDI)

NT Aboriginal Investment grants

Queensland First Nations Business Acceleration Program

Q11. How confident are you in using the Stage 2 grant opportunity to secure additional or matching funding?

Very confident

Q12. What factors influence your level of confidence in using the Stage 2 grant opportunity to secure additional or matching funding?

1. Demonstrated Funder Traction:

We have an exceptional track record of converting philanthropic relationships into sustained support. Snow Foundation has increased their investment across three consecutive grants (from \$25K → \$25K → \$100K → \$200K proposed). The Funding Network selected us as finalists and we raised \$130,000 at a single pitch event - the largest single raise in Goods history. This demonstrates funders see both impact and potential.

2. Strong Demand Signal:

We have 200-350 beds requested from communities and health organisations - more demand than we can currently meet. Alice Springs Homelands alone wants 200+ beds and a number of washing machines. This isn't speculative - these are documented requests from health workers, housing providers, and community leaders who've seen our products work. Diane Stokes received one bed and came back within two weeks requesting twenty more, offering to self-fund.

3. Clear Path to Revenue:

Unlike many social enterprises, we have a tangible product that generates revenue. Current production cost is \$300-400 per bed; retail price is \$500-700. At scale (1,000+ beds in inventory), we can achieve sustainable margins while maintaining the 40% community profit share.

4. Asset-Based Model:

Our production facility isn't a sunk cost - it's an asset. Communities may pay ~\$5,000/week to host the facility, creating local jobs while producing products. This creates multiple revenue pathways beyond direct sales.

5. Sector Alignment:

We sit at the intersection of three funded priorities: circular economy/climate, First Nations economic development, and remote health infrastructure. Matching funds from Catalysing Impact would signal to impact investors that we're investment-ready, not just grant-dependent.

6. Team Credibility:

Our co-founder Nicholas Marchesi OAM co-founded Orange Sky (2016 Young Australian of the Year, now serving 280+ shifts weekly). Funders trust his track record of scaling community impact.

Q13. Does your enterprise have the capacity to participate in Catalysing Impact's activities (e.g. induction, advisory, mentoring, hackathon, etc.)?

Selected enterprises will receive a participation grant of \$10,000, which is to cover the time and costs of participating in the program.

Yes

Q14. Where did you first learn about the program?

SIH Social Media

QBE Social Media

Other Social Media

Word of Mouth